

Exercise 4 – Mapping the Gulfs

In pairs, choose a real interaction sequence with multiple steps and some built-in waiting – a vending machine, an ATM withdrawal, a lift call, a toll gate, a printer jam, a food delivery app tracking a rider.

Storyboard it in 6-8 panels, labelling each panel with its stage in Norman's model (goal, plan, specify, perform, perceive, interpret, compare).

Mark clearly where a gulf of execution or gulf of evaluation opens up – the exact panel where someone could plausibly not know what to do next, or not be able to tell what just happened.

Note how long that gap lasts and what, if anything, fills it.